

## CONTACT

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## SUMMARY

High-impact Financial Leader and CPA with 12+ years of experience across Public and Private Practice. Specialized in Strategic Controllershship and Organizational Upskilling. Proven track record of defending multi-million peso tax positions while simultaneously building internal training academies to reduce turnover and increase technical literacy

## CORE COMPETENCIES

- Philippine Taxation & Regulatory Compliance | Tax Defense and Negotiation
- Leadership and Development
- Financial Controlling | PFRS | IFRS

## KEY TECHNOLOGY EXPERTISE

SAP | Quickbooks | Xero | Sage  
Google Suite | Microsoft Office  
Slack | Asana

## EDUCATION

University of Santo Tomas  
B.S. Accountancy  
2012

# ROMAR JOHN E. VERGARA, CPA

Strategic Controllershship | Tax Expert | Talent Upskilling | Dale Carnegie Trained

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Trends Group, Inc. | Controlling Manager | March 2023 - Present

- Regional Portfolio Oversight: Directly managed the financial and tax compliance landscape for 22 distinct entities across the Philippines and Singapore.
- Tax Defense: Consistently reconciled and negotiated tax examinations to achieve an 80–90% reduction in initial assessments.
- Departmental Upskilling: Acted as the internal "Technical Trainer," conducting seminars on accounting, taxation, technical writing, and conflict resolution to build a more robust finance team.
- Governance Lead: Represented the Controlling function for ISO 9001 and 27001 certifications, aligning internal processes with global standards.

### HealthNow, Inc. | Accounting & Tax Manager | December 2020 - December 2022

- M&A Advisory: Handled complex tax documentation for merger and acquisition activities, including CAR applications and due diligence.
- Policy Architecture: Established foundational accounting and taxation policies with a focus on digital integration and scalability.
- Sector Consultation: Conducted risk assessments and tax best-practice discussions for medical practitioners and partner institutions.

### Tech1 Corporation | Accounting & Tax Consultation | February 2020 to April 2020

- Record Reconstruction: Fully reconstructed accounting and tax records for a full fiscal year within 2 months, resulting in zero material audit findings.
- Team Mentorship: Provided targeted training to the finance department on tax compliance and year-end reporting adjustments.

### Villaruz, Villaruz & Co., CPAs | Junior Partner (Progression from Associate) | November 2012 – December 2019

- Organizational Transformation: Modernized the firm's performance evaluation program, cutting promotion processing time and staff turnover by 50% while doubling employee satisfaction scores.
- Training Authority: Co-developed the Firms' Tax and Audit training curriculum and served as the primary "Trainer of Trainers" to ensure continuing development of colleagues.
- Tax Infrastructure: Built a decentralized tax database that empowered the team to resolve concerns independently, creating capacity for a 25% increase in new client onboarding.
- Litigation Success: Led a specialized team in a 45-day evidence compilation project commissioned by the Court of Tax Appeals, resulting in an P800 Million tax refund (en banc decision)
- Departmental Leadership: Appointed as the youngest Tax Team Chairperson, supervising 12 professionals and managing daily tax advisory workflows.
- Technical Advocacy: Represented a high-growth tech company before the BIR, successfully negotiating a 70%+ reduction in assessed tax deficiencies through technical reconciliation.